

William O'Brochta

wobrochta@tlu.edu • www.williamobrochta.net

Department of Political Science • Texas Lutheran University • Seguin, Texas

POSITIONS	Assistant Professor of Political Science, Texas Lutheran University (2023–present) Hugo & Georgia Gibson Endowed Professor (2026–present) Chair, Department of Political Science (2026–present) Assistant Professor of Political Science, Louisiana Tech University (2021–2023)
EDUCATION AND TRAINING	Washington University in Saint Louis, Missouri Ph.D., Political Science (2021) M.A., Political Science (2018) Hendrix College, Conway, Arkansas B.A., Politics and Mathematics, <i>summa cum laude</i> (2016) Budapest Semesters in Mathematics (2014)
EXPERTISE	Teaching writing, civic engagement, representation, identity, political elites, violence, public service provision, grievances, event data, media, India, post-Communist states
PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES	30. “ Students Build Skills Self-Assessing Their Class Notes ,” 2026. <i>Journal of College Reading and Learning</i> 56(1): 34–47. 29. “ How Human Coding is Used and Described ,” 2026. <i>Political Studies Review</i> 24(2): 335–347. 28. “ Social Benefits Motivate Young Adult Civic Engagement ,” 2026. <i>PS: Political Science & Politics</i> 59(1): 1–8. 27. “ Language Cues and Perceptions of Nationalism ” (with Patrick Cunha Silva), 2025. <i>Political Behavior</i> 47: 1687–1710. 26. “ Quantifying and Contextualizing Violent Collective Action Event Datasets ” (with Sunita Parikh), 2025. <i>Social Indicators Research</i> 176: 883–902. 25. “ Public Discourse About Autonomous Regions and De Facto States ,” 2024. <i>Studies in Ethnicity and Nationalism</i> 24(3): 387–402. 24. “ Lower-Stakes Legislative Collaborations, Ethnicity, and Gender ,” 2024. <i>Political Research Quarterly</i> 77(4): 1081–1095. 23. “ Ethnic Cabinet Diversity, Co-Ethnic Representation, and Attitudes Toward Government ,” 2025. <i>Journal of Elections, Public Opinion, and Parties</i> 35(4): 857–867. 22. “ Gendered Ideologies, Gendered Perceptions: Do Nationalist Symbols and Gender Affect People’s Perceptions of Politicians? ” (with Patrick Cunha Silva), 2025. <i>Politics, Groups, and Identities</i> 13(1): 46–63. 21. “ Sustaining and Supporting the Momentum of Enduring Pandemic Practices ” (with Sarah McCorkle, Cathy Box, and Mary-Catherine Dean), 2024. <i>To Improve the Academy: A Journal of Educational Development</i> 43(1): 197–224.

20. [“Tweeting Public Service Complaints,”](#) 2023. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media* 3: 1–49.
Best Paper Engaged in Quantitative Description on an Under-Studied Phenomenon Published from 2021 to 2023 (Runner Up)
19. [“Elite Responses to Ethnic Diversity and Interethnic Contact,”](#) 2024. *Political Behavior* 46: 1057–1077.
18. [“Politicians’ Complaint Response: E-Governance and Personal Relationships,”](#) 2023. *Governance* 36(4): 1147–1164.
17. [“Ethnic Representational Priorities and Political Engagement in Deeply Divided Societies,”](#) 2022. *Nations and Nationalism* 28(3): 777–787.
16. [“Perceptions of Partisanship in Local Television News,”](#) 2022. *Electronic News* 16(1): 3–17.
15. [“Can Policy Responses to Pandemics Reduce Mass Fear?”](#) (with Michael Bechtel and Margit Tavits), 2023. *Journal of Experimental Political Science* 10(3): 343–353.
14. [“Completing the Research Article Writing Process in an Introductory Course,”](#) 2022. *Journal of Political Science Education* 18(1): 35–51.
13. [“Signaling Democratic Progress with Electoral System Reform”](#) (with Patrick Cunha Silva), 2022. *Political Research Quarterly* 75(4): 1037–1050.
12. [“Small-Scale Civic Engagement with Big Impacts,”](#) 2022. *PS: Political Science & Politics* 55(2): 389–391.
11. [“Citizen Responses to Ethnic Representation,”](#) 2023. *Political Studies* 71(2): 418–439.
10. [“Anomalous Responses on Amazon Mechanical Turk: An Indian Perspective”](#) (with Sunita Parikh), 2021. *Research and Politics* 8(2): 1–4.
9. [“Do Peers Respond? Attendance and Critical Events,”](#) 2021. *British Politics* 16(4): 456–468.
8. [“Technology and Collective Action Event Size: Lessons for India,”](#) 2021. *Studies in Indian Politics* 9(1): 118–123.
7. [“Western Political Rhetoric and Radicalization”](#) (with Margit Tavits and Deniz Aksoy). 2022. *British Journal of Political Science* 52(1): 437–444.
6. [“Ethnic Diversity in Central Government Cabinets.”](#) 2022. *Politics, Groups, and Identities* 10(2): 189–208.
5. [“Pick Your Language: How Riot Reporting Differs Between English and Hindi Newspapers in India,”](#) 2019. *Asian Journal of Communication* 29(5): 405–423.
4. [“A Meta-Analysis of Natural Resources and Conflict,”](#) 2019. *Research and Politics* 6(1): 1–6.
3. [“Regional Autonomy in Rich Regions: Evidence from Adjara, Georgia,”](#) 2018. *Caucasus Survey* 6(1): 18–41.
2. [“International Tourism’s Impact on Regional Autonomy: Evidence from 2004 EU Accession Countries,”](#) 2017. *Tourism Economics* 23(8): 1632–1661.
1. [“Did Natural Resource Wealth Motivate Fighting in the Bosnian War?”](#) 2016. *Journal of International Studies* 9(1): 27–43.

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| BOOK CHAPTERS | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 4. “Multidisciplinary and Combined Departments” (with Brenda Savage), 2025. In Daniel Mallinson, Julia Marin Hellwege, and Joseph Roberts (eds.) <i>Elgar Encyclopedia of Teaching and Pedagogy in Political Science</i>. 3. “Civic Engagement at Teaching-Focused Universities: Challenges for Pre-Tenure Faculty” (with Kevin Lorentz II and Kim Saks), 2024. In Lauren Bell, Allison Rank, and Carah Ong Whaley (eds.) <i>Civic Pedagogy: Teaching Civic Engagement in an Era of Divisive Politics</i>. Cham, Switzerland: Palgrave Macmillan. 2. “You have an Academic Job Offer...Now What? Negotiating Advice from Two Perspectives” (with Lori Poloni-Staudinger), 2022. In Kevin Lorenz II, Daniel Mallinson, Julia Marin Hellwege, Davin Phoenix, and J. Cherie Strachan (eds.) <i>Strategies for Navigating Graduate School and Beyond</i>. Washington, D.C.: American Political Science Association. 1. “Research Articles, Not Research Papers: Empowering Students Through Research Writing,” 2021. In Daniel Mallinson, Julia Marin Hellwege, and Eric Loepp (eds.) <i>Handbook of Political Research Pedagogy</i>. Cham, Switzerland: Palgrave Macmillan, 367–378. |
| EDITOR | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 2. “Centering Career Preparation in Political Science” at the <i>Journal of Political Science Education</i>. 1. “Vocation Ground Game: Equipping for Civic Engagement,” 2026. <i>Intersections: Faith, Learning, and the Vocation of Lutheran Higher Education</i> 63. |
| OTHER PUBLICATIONS | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> 8. “American Government Activity Workbook” (with Julia Marin Hellwege), 2026. OpenStax. 7. “Civic Engagement and Faith Perspectives,” 2026. <i>Intersections: Faith, Learning, and the Vocation of Lutheran Higher Education</i> 63: 8–11. 6. “Track Summary: Career Preparation in the Political Science Curriculum” (with Cameron Arnzen, Ivy Orr Hamerly, Chloe O’Neill, Rebecca Grace Tan, and Joshua Wood), 2025. <i>Political Science Today</i> 5(3): 20–22. 5. “Review of <i>What Teaching Looks Like: Higher Education Through Photographs</i>,” 2023. <i>Journal of Political Science Education</i> 19(4): 737–739. 4. “The Benefits of Early Student Involvement with Civic Engagement Programs” (with Anthony Franklin), 2023. <i>The Political Science Educator</i> 27(1): 76–79. Reprinted in <i>Political Science Today</i> 4(1): 11–12. 3. “Track Summary: Teaching Research, Writing, and Information Literacy: How to Handle Misinformation” (with Michele Calderon, Heather Katz, and Rachel Olsen), 2023. <i>Political Science Today</i> 3(3): 11–13. 2. “Department-Level Graduate Student Peer Teaching Workshops” (with Bryant Moy), 2021. <i>The Political Science Educator</i> 25(1): 6–8. 1. “Track Summary: Teaching Research, Writing, and Information Literacy” (with Julia Marin Hellwege), 2020. <i>PS: Political Science & Politics</i> 53(3): 588–590. |

PUBLIC
SCHOLARSHIP

7. APSA Civic Engagement Panel Moderator
 - [Constitution Day as a Signature Event](#)
 - [What are Successful Constitution Day Ideas?](#)
 - [Community Partnership Opportunities and Goals](#)
 - [Best Practices for Working with Community Partners](#)
 - [Civic Engagement Experiences with Dual Enrollment Students](#)
 - [Future of High School Students and Civic Engagement](#)
 - [Mentoring Students for Civic Engagement Careers](#)
 - [Effective Mentor-Mentee Relationships in Academia](#)
 - [Lessons from Required Civic Engagement Experiences](#)
 - [How Do Political Science Programs Align with Civic Engagement?](#)
 - [What Does a Non-Profit Career Look Like?](#)
 - [How Do I Get Started with a Non-Profit Career?](#)
 - [Getting Started with Classroom Civic Engagement Activities](#)
6. [“Breakthroughs in Civic Education Research,”](#) 2026. *We the People: National Symposium on Civic Education*.
5. [“Faculty Scholarship Resources,”](#) 2025. *TLU Library LibGuide*.
4. [“Author Interview: How Human Coding is Used and Described,”](#) 2025. *Political Studies Review Author Interview Series*.
3. [“Peers in UK government: Roles and Sitting Attendance,”](#) 2021. *UK in a Changing Europe Blog*.
2. [“Members of the Lords Attended More Sittings Following Crises that Affected their Jobs but not crises that Affected the Public,”](#) 2021. *LSE Politics & Policy Blog*.
1. [“Civic Engagement Projects in Online Courses,”](#) 2020. *APSA Educate Blog*.

WORKING PAPERS

6. “Territorial Dispute Resolution and Intergroup Relations” (with Amaan Charaniya and Deniz Aksoy). Revise and resubmit.
5. *Grievance to Nowhere: Formal Institutions Delivering Government Services* (book).
4. “Civic Engagement on Campus, for Campus” (with Andie Lozano-Lomeli, book chapter).
3. “Doing Quantitative Description” (book chapter).
2. “Approaches to Coding Caste” (with Sunita Parikh). Revise and resubmit.
1. [“Political Space in Competitive Authoritarian Regimes: Activating Pro Forma Platforms”](#) (with Norman Schofield).

STUDENT
RESEARCH

Theses

- Allegra Negrete (Chair, 2025–2026): *Legal Challenges to Higher Education Access and Support*
- Julie Cupples (Chair, 2022–2023): *Addressing the Lack of Due Process Rights in the American Immigration System*
- Victoria Phillips (Chair, 2022–2023): *Affirmative Action in Higher Education: An Examination into the Legal Repercussions of its Elimination*
- Emily Meaney (2021–2022): *From Latin America to the United States: Immigration Trends Throughout the Covid-19 Pandemic*

Collaborative Scholarship

- Andie Lozano-Lomeli (2025–present): Interviews on student perceptions of on-campus civic engagement, analysis of vocation data, study of workplace and civic engagement
- Ruby Wilsford (2025–present): Marketing and resources for sustainability projects
- Emma Bohmann and Monica Sitachitta (2025): Vocation conference reflections
- Izzie Stephens (2025): Analysis of student engagement focus group data
- Moo Holstein (2024): Analysis of class action lawsuits
- Myla Mitchell (2024): Collection and nationalism analysis of historical markers
- Anthony Franklin (2023): Project on student input in civic engagement planning

Group Scholarship

- *John Doe VII v. Exxon Mobil Corporation* (2026, 11 students): Analyzed district and appellate court arguments related to human rights violations
- Constitutional Arguments for Religious Discrimination (2023, 3 students): Compared Indian and U.S. constitutional provisions related to religious discrimination
- Legal Motivations for Politicians to Respond (2023, 13 students): Developed legal arguments for politicians' duty to respond to citizen complaints

Campus Research Projects

- Campus Sustainability Audit (2025–2026, 24 students): Conduct a campus-wide sustainability audit aligned with AASHE STARS reporting framework
- A Student-Centered Vision: Committing to Student Engagement (2024–2025, 31 students): Collect data on student engagement, conduct interviews, and facilitate focus groups contributing to strategic planning work
- Community, Knowledge, Culture: Student Civic Engagement Survey Team (2022–2023, 40 students): Design and implement representative campus survey ($N=1,118$) and nine focus groups about civic engagement improvements
- Proposal to Increase Student Civic Engagement (2021–2022, 13 students): Strategic plan for three-year effort to study civic engagement
- Environmental Issue Representative Contact (2020, 12 students): Develop training lessons for high school students on reporting environmental issues

Student Presentations and Recognition

- Recognition: Andie Lozano-Lomeli (2026 Sumners Foundation scholar), Moo Holstein (2025 valedictorian equivalent), Madie Lake (2024 valedictorian equivalent), Johnathan Rodriguez (2024 salutatorian equivalent), Victoria Phillips (2023 most outstanding graduate)
- Vocation of Lutheran Higher Education: Emma Bohmann (2026), Andie Lozano-Lomeli (2026)
- Scholarship Showcase: Allegra Negrete (2026), Ruby Wilsford (2026), Izzie Stephens (2025), Sophia Short (2025), Myla Mitchell (2024), Madie Lake (2024), Johnathan Rodriguez (2024), Moo Holstein (discussant, 2024)
- TLU Senior Administration: Andie Lozano-Lomeli (2026), Izzie Stephens (2025), Allegra Negrete (2024), Moo Holstein (2024)
- Southern Political Science Association Summer Conference: Myla Mitchell (2024)
- Louisiana Political Science Association: Victoria Phillips (2023), Caroline Clifton (2022), Sarah Szwak (2022)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Causes of War and Peace (Spring 2027)
- International Relations (Spring 2027, Spring 2025)
- Comparative Political Economy (Spring 2027, Spring 2025)
- First-Year Experience: Exploring the Arts and Sciences (Fall 2026, Fall 2025, Fall 2024)
- Data Analysis in Social Science (Fall 2026, Fall 2025, Fall 2024, Fall 2023, cross-list sociology/criminal justice)

	• American Politics I (Fall 2026 x2, Fall 2025 x2, Fall 2024 x2, Spring 2024 x2, Fall 2023 x2, Spring 2023, Winter 2023 x2, Fall 2022 x2, Spring 2022 x2, Winter 2022 x2, Fall 2021) • Civic Engagement and Political Behavior (Summer 2026, independent study) • Research and Data Analysis in Vocational Studies (Spring 2026, independent study) • Public Administration (Spring 2026, cross-list communication studies and social innovation and social entrepreneurship) • Asia and Development (Spring 2026, Fall 2023, cross-list economics and social innovation and social entrepreneurship) • Comparative Politics (Spring 2026, Spring 2024, Fall 2022, Fall 2021, Summer 2019) • Legal Research and Policy Analysis (Fall 2025, Summer 2025, Spring 2025, independent study) • Environmental Politics (Spring 2025) • Qualitative Research Methods and Writing (Spring 2025, independent study) • Legal Research and Writing (Fall 2024, independent study) • Electoral Politics (Spring 2024) • Nationalism and Political Behavior (Spring 2024, independent study) • Politics of Developing Nations (Spring 2023) • Intelligence Policy and Analysis (Spring 2023) • Representation, Identity, and Community (Spring 2022) • Scope and Methods in the Social Sciences (Winter 2023, Winter 2022) • Representation, Identity, and Dissent (Summer 2020, online) • Immigration, Identity, and the Internet (Fall 2018, co-instructor) • Internship Supervisor
PEDAGOGICAL CERTIFICATIONS	• Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Scholar, Washington University, 2020 • Washington University Teaching Citation, 2019
INVITED CLASSES AND TALKS	Indian Institute of Technology Bombay, 2026 Shri Vile Parle Kelavani Mandal's Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies, 2026 Washington University in St. Louis, 2025
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	Vocation of Lutheran Higher Education, 2026 Southwestern Social Science Association, 2026 National Symposium on Civic Education, 2026 (Moderator) Texas Comparative Circle, 2026 Association for the Study of Nationalities, 2025 Texas Methods Conference, 2025 Network for Vocation in Undergraduate Education Regional Gathering, 2024 Engaging Pedagogy Conference, 2024 Southern Political Science Association, 2024 (Summer Conference), 2024 Midwest Political Science Association, 2026, 2024, 2018–2022 American Political Science Association, 2025–2026 (Research Group), 2024–2025, 2017–2022 American Political Science Association Standalone Teaching and Learning Conference, 2025, 2023, 2020 Descriptive Research Conference, 2022 Professional and Organizational Development Network Conference, 2021 Washington University Graduate Research Symposium, 2021 Washington University — University of Illinois Student Exchange Conference, 2021 Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium Conference, 2019 Fifth International Conference on Political Economy and Institutions, 2017

Arkansas Political Science Association, 2016

SERVICE

Discipline

Director of Professional Development, APSA Civic Engagement Section (2023–present)
APSA Civic Learning Working Group (2026–present)
External Program Reviewer (2025)
Organizer, Civic Engagement and Faith Perspectives Conference (2025)
Track Moderator, APSA Teaching and Learning Conference (2025)
Organizer, APSA Civic Engagement Workshop (2025, 2024)
APSA Awards Committee: Emerging Scholar (2026), Outstanding Civic Engagement Project (2024, 2023, 2022)
Editorial Assistant, *The Journal of Politics* (2020)
Discussant:
MPSA (2017–2026), APSA (2024), SPSA (2024), Professional and Organizational Development Network (2021), Louisiana Political Science Association (2023, 2022)
Panelist:
“Teaching in Troubling Times,” SSSA, 2026
“How to Approach the Job Interview,” MPSA, 2024
“Preparing for the Academic Job Market,” APSA, 2022

University

- Texas Lutheran University
 - Interim Chair, Guadalupe County Community Symposium, 2026–present
 - Advisor, Sexuality Awareness for Everyone Club, 2026–present
 - Pre-Law Advisor, 2025–present
 - Director, Faculty Scholarship Development, 2025–present
 - Director, Dr. Donald H. Nelson Environmental Conservation and Sustainability Fund, 2025–present
 - Advisor, Beta Alpha Sigma Sorority, 2025–present
 - Undergraduate Research, Scholarship, and Creative Activities Committee, 2025–present
 - Co-Coordinator, Faculty Community Building, 2024–present
 - Faculty Marshal, 2024–present
 - Founder and Advisor, CIVIC Club (Creating InVolved Individuals and Communities), 2024–present
 - Honors Program Advisory Committee, 2024–present
 - Environmental Sustainability Committee, 2024–present
 - Teacher Education Committee, 2024–present
 - Trumpet, TLU Symphonic Winds, 2024–present
 - Service Learning, Career Development, and Civic Engagement Committee, 2023–present
 - Founder and Advisor, Pi Sigma Alpha Honor Society (Alpha Mu Psi), 2023–present
 - Student Engagement Award Committee, 2026, 2025, 2024
 - Faculty Co-Leader, Holden Village Study Away Trip, 2025
 - Vocation of Lutheran Higher Education Conference, 2026, 2024
- Louisiana Tech University
 - Analysis and Investigation of Cyber Scenarios, 2021–2023
 - American Democracy Project Campus Coordinator, 2022–2023
 - Evaluation of Administrators Policy Committee, 2022
 - Science Olympiad Event Supervisor, 2023, 2022
 - School of History and Social Science Curriculum Committee, 2022–2023
- Washington University

- Fellow, Center for Teaching and Learning, Washington University, 2021
- Founder and Facilitator, Teaching Political Science Workshop Series, 2019–2021
- Pedagogy Specialist, Department of Political Science, 2020
- Graduate Student Organizer, Comparative Politics Conference, 2020–2021
- Teaching Center Orientation Mentor, 2018–2021
- Teaching Center Graduate Student Advisory Council, 2017–2020
- University Graduate Advisory Council, 2018–2019
- University Teaching and Professional Development Committee, 2018–2019
- Graduate Student Senate Sustainability Committee, 2016–2017
- Hendrix College
 - Chief Sustainability Officer, 2015–2016
 - Presidential Ambassador, 2014–2016
 - Strategic Planning Committee, 2015–2016
 - Financial Committee, 2015

Reviewer

PS: Political Science & Politics, Conflict Management and Peace Science, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Springer Verlag, Professional and Organizational Development Network, *American Political Science Review, Journal of Elections, Public Opinion, and Parties, Tourism Economics, Research & Politics, Nationalism and Ethnic Politics, Public Choice, Journal of Politics, Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics, Journal of Contemporary European Studies, Perspectives on Psychological Science, New Perspectives, Central Asian Survey, Journal of Political Science Education, Journal of Balkan and Near Eastern Studies*, National Science Centre Poland, National Science Foundation

HONORS AND AWARDS

Grants

- J. Robert and Mary S. Cade Vanguard Award (\$3,000), 2026
- Summer Research Grant
 - \$3,500: Civic engagement and workplaces (with Andie Lozano-Lomeli), 2026
 - \$5,000: Higher education legal research (with Allegra Negrete), 2025
- Krost Life Enrichment Fund (\$1,012.41, with Allegra Negrete, Madison Wright, and Lauren Fjetland), 2026
- Academic Development & Research Grant (\$1,200), 2026, 2025
- Assessment Coordinator, Network for Vocation in Undergraduate Education Campuswide Innovation in Vocation Planning Grant (team lead Wes Cain, \$23,996), 2025
- Innovative Course Release Grant (\$3,000), 2025, 2024
- Pi Sigma Alpha Start-Up Grant (\$750), 2025
- Weidenbaum Center on the Economy, Government, and Public Policy
 - \$14,910: Fieldwork in India (with Sunita Parikh), 2025
 - \$9,600: Surveys in India (with Sunita Parikh), 2021
 - \$11,000: Survey experiments (with Margit Tavits), 2019
 - \$4,500: Surveys in India (with Sunita Parikh), 2019
 - \$8,900: Survey experiments in India and Macedonia (with Sunita Parikh), 2018
- The Brandes Fund for Religious Activities
 - \$3,702: Conference presentation (with Andie Lozano-Lomeli and Emma Bohmann), 2026
 - \$4,353: Civic engagement and faith perspectives conference, 2024
 - Holden Village program (with Kathleen Seal and Tiffany Sia), 2024
- Department of Political Science Seed Grant (\$1,500), 2020
- Professional and Organizational Development Network Career Grant, 2020
- American Political Science Association Travel Grant, 2023, 2017
- Hendrix Provost Scholarship (full merit scholarship), 2012–2016

Awards

- Hugo & Georgia Gibson Endowed Professorship for integrating vocational discernment into learning, 2026–present
- J. Robert and Mary S. Cade Vanguard Award for enriching cultural, spiritual, or intellectual life, 2026
- Emerging Scholar Award, American Political Science Association Civic Engagement Section, 2025
- Best Chapter Award, Pi Sigma Alpha, 2025
- Highly Established Action Plan, All in Campus Democracy Project, 2024, 2026
- Best Paper Engaged in Quantitative Description on an Under-Studied Phenomenon Published from 2021 to 2023 (Runner Up), *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*
- Pi Sigma Alpha (Politics), Pi Mu Epsilon (Mathematics)
- Graduate Research Symposium Best Poster (3rd Place)
- W.C. Butthman Prize in Politics
- Parker Mathematics Undergraduate Research Award
- Mathematics Association of America Best Presentation Award

SKILLS

Fieldwork: Chennai, Delhi, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai Metropolitan Region

Computer: L^AT_EX, R, Stata, SPSS, Python, Qualtrics

Additional Training: Python, Network Analysis, GIS, Advanced Causal Inference